Jay-Z Will Finally Perform at the Super Bowl Halftime Show

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Rapper Jay-Z will take the Super Bowl **halftime** stage in February, the NFL has announced. It will be his first time performing at the championship game, even though his company, Roc Nation, has produced the **halftime** show since 2019 and he has helped pick each year's performer.

Super Bowl LXI will take place on February 14 near Los Angeles. Jay-Z will follow recent **halftime** stars including Bad Bunny, Kendrick Lamar, Usher, Rihanna and The Weeknd. The show draws global attention, while tens of millions of people in the United States watch the game.

Kendrick Lamar's 2025 performance was the most watched Super Bowl **halftime** show in history and won the Emmy award for outstanding music direction. The announcement came after Jay-Z, whose real name is Shawn Carter, performed two shows last weekend at the Los Angeles stadium where the Super Bowl will be played, as part of a tour celebrating the 30th **anniversary** of his **debut** album, Reasonable Doubt.

From Reasonable Doubt to standing on the Super Bowl **halftime** stage, this has been a journey, Jay-Z said. Thirty years of music, work, and culture on the world's biggest stage. This run continues to be a dream come true. NFL **commissioner** Roger Goodell said he couldn't be more excited for fans around the world to experience the artistry, creativity and cultural impact Jay-Z will bring.

Goodell added that when the NFL first agreed with Roc Nation to produce the show, he had just one request: that Jay-Z take the stage himself one day, whenever the moment felt right to him. Jay-Z's honors include being the first rapper **inducted** into the Songwriters Hall of Fame, 25 Grammy awards, and induction into the Rock and Roll Hall of Fame in 2021.

Word Treasure

halftime -- Halftime is the break in the middle of a game, when a big music show takes place.

commissioner -- A commissioner is the person in charge of a sports league.

debut -- A debut album is the first album an artist ever releases.

inducted -- To be inducted into a Hall of Fame means to be formally welcomed as a member for great work.

anniversary -- An anniversary is a date that marks a number of years since something first happened.

Background you need

The Super Bowl is the championship game of American football, and its halftime show is a huge music performance watched by huge crowds.

A halftime show is planned like a concert in the middle of the game, with a star performer and a big stage.

Roc Nation is Jay-Z's company, which has helped produce the halftime show and pick its performers.

For a performer, headlining the show is a major honour, because it puts their music before one of the largest audiences in entertainment.

Break it down

LEAD: Jay-Z will headline the Super Bowl LXI halftime show on February 14 near Los Angeles, his first time performing at the game.

KEY EVENT: The NFL announced Jay-Z as the halftime performer after he sang two shows at the Los Angeles stadium as part of a tour for the 30th anniversary of Reasonable Doubt.

+- WHO: Jay-Z, whose real name is Shawn Carter, and NFL commissioner Roger Goodell.

+- BACKGROUND: Roc Nation has produced the halftime show since 2019, and Jay-Z has helped pick each year's performer.

+- CONTEXT: He follows Bad Bunny, Kendrick Lamar, Usher, Rihanna and The Weeknd, and Lamar's 2025 show was the most watched and won an Emmy for outstanding music direction.

EVIDENCE: Jay-Z called the run a dream come true, and Goodell said he could not be more excited for fans to experience Jay-Z's artistry, creativity and cultural impact.

NOTE: Goodell recalled that his one request when the NFL first agreed with Roc Nation was that Jay-Z take the stage himself one day, whenever the moment felt right.

Why it matters

It shows how a long music career can lead to one of the world's biggest stages, and how the artists behind a show can finally step into the spotlight themselves.

Test what you remember

1. When and where will Super Bowl LXI take place?

- (A) February 14 in New York
- (B) March 14 near Los Angeles
- (C) February 14 near Los Angeles
- (D) January 14 near Los Angeles

2. What is new about Jay-Z's appearance at the Super Bowl halftime show?

- (A) It is his first time visiting Los Angeles
- (B) It is his first time producing the show
- (C) It is his first time performing at the championship game
- (D) It is his first time watching the game

3. Which company has produced the halftime show since 2019?

- (A) Bad Bunny's company
- (B) The Weeknd's company
- (C) The NFL itself
- (D) Roc Nation

4. Whose 2025 halftime performance was the most watched in history?

- (A) Usher
- (B) Rihanna
- (C) The Weeknd
- (D) Kendrick Lamar

5. What is Jay-Z's real name?

- (A) Roger Goodell
- (B) Kendrick Lamar
- (C) Bad Bunny
- (D) Shawn Carter

6. How many Grammy awards has Jay-Z won, according to the article?

- (A) 15
- (B) 21
- (C) 30
- (D) 25

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: D 4: D 5: D 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Jay-Z: He says the journey from Reasonable Doubt to the Super Bowl halftime stage has been a dream come true.

2. NFL commissioner Roger Goodell: He says he could not be more excited for fans around the world to experience Jay-Z's artistry, creativity and cultural impact, and recalls asking that Jay-Z take the stage himself one day.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):